

the presentation code and the colour is being controlled via the external style sheet. From this point on whatever changes are needed within the site in terms of style and presentation can be done directly through a single external style sheet. Also, once a browser accesses the style sheet, it caches it and wouldn't need to keep downloading it each time it accesses it. Rather, it only downloads the page content. This will make your website faster and also keep your HTML clean.

1.5 Importing styles

The `@import` rule is a method for importing one or more style sheets via the main external style sheet.

Continuing from the previous example,

1. Open the `imported.html` file in your text editor.
2. Within the `<head>` section, and after the `<title>` element, paste the element `<style type="text/css">@import url(external.css);</style>`
3. Save `imported.html` and view it in the browser. Nothing looks different, and the paragraphs are still red, but this is a sensible and productive way of style sheet management.

The `@import` rule is also useful for hiding your style sheet from really old out-dated browsers with poor CSS support such as Netscape 4.x, and IE4 that don't support `@import`. Rather than attempt to do something half-useful with your CSS, these browsers will just completely ignore your style sheet and leave the HTML unstyled.

1.6 Maintaining and organising style sheets

1.6.1 Style Sheets for different media

All modern browsers support the common media attributes that are applied within the `<link>` element to target specific style sheets in a specific situation. For example, to ensure only visitors viewing the web site on a monitor see your glamorous design, you add `media="screen"` to the `<link>` element to call your default style sheet. Underneath that, a second `<link>` element can be used with `media="print"` added to call a print style sheet with only basic styling such as black text on a plain white background, and all graphics removed:

```
<link rel="stylesheet" media="screen" type="text/css" href="screen.css" />
```